

LEONIDAS LIFTS

# Starter Supplement Stack

*5 Compounds for the Natural Lifter*

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# THE LEONIDAS LIFTS STARTER SUPPLEMENT STACK

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## For the Natural Lifter — Build the Foundation First

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This is the baseline supplement stack for anyone running the Leonidas Lifts Training Program. Five compounds. No peptides. No hormones. No gray-zone research chemicals. These are the five supplements that earned their place through published research and 18+ years of personal application. If you are new to structured training, start here and stay here for at least two years before considering anything beyond this list.

**Prerequisite:** You should already be training 5+ days/week consistently and hitting 200g+ protein daily from whole food sources. Supplements do not replace food — they fill gaps that food alone cannot cover efficiently. If your nutrition is not locked, close this document and go read Nutrition Plan V3.

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*Backed by 7 peer-reviewed studies — verified May 2026.*

## The Stack — Exactly 5 Compounds

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### 1. Fadogia Agrestis

**What it does:** Stimulates luteinizing hormone (LH)-mediated testosterone synthesis via saponin compounds acting on Leydig cells. Supports natural testosterone production without exogenous hormone introduction.

**Dosing:** Follow the product label (typically 600 mg of 10:1 extract). **Cycle: 5 days on / 2 days off**, with a 2-week break every 6–8 weeks. Cycling is mandatory — Yakubu et al. (2009; [DOI](#))

documented plasma-membrane disruption in hepatocytes and nephrons at sustained doses in rat models.

**Why it's in the stack:** Natural testosterone optimization is the single highest-leverage intervention for a natural lifter's recovery and muscle protein synthesis. Fadogia is one of the few compounds with a plausible mechanism for stimulating endogenous production rather than introducing exogenous hormones.

**Important:** No human randomized controlled trials exist as of 2026. All evidence is from animal models. Nephrotoxicity has been documented at higher doses in animal studies. If you run Fadogia, pair it with NAC and TUDCA (see Nutrition Plan V3 supplement stack) for liver and kidney support, and monitor bloodwork quarterly.

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## 2. Tongkat Ali (*Eurycoma longifolia*)

**What it does:** Reduces sex hormone-binding globulin (SHBG), which frees more testosterone to be biologically active. Also stimulates Leydig cell function independently of Fadogia's LH pathway. Chinnappan, George et al. (2021; [DOI](#)) — a randomised, double-blind, placebo-controlled trial with 105 ageing male subjects — demonstrated significant testosterone increases over 12 weeks vs. placebo.

**Dosing:** Follow the product label (typically 400 mg standardized extract with BioPerine for absorption). Can be taken continuously — the George et al. trial used daily dosing for 12+ weeks with sustained benefit and no adverse effects requiring cycling.

**Why it's in the stack:** Complementary to Fadogia. Fadogia pushes LH → testosterone production. Tongkat Ali reduces SHBG → more free testosterone available. Together they address both the production and the bioavailability sides of natural testosterone optimization.

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## 3. Creatine Monohydrate

**What it does:** Saturates intramuscular phosphocreatine stores, increasing ATP regeneration during high-intensity efforts. The single most studied and validated sports supplement in history. Rawson & Volek (2003) systematic review ([DOI](#)): creatine supplementation increases strength by 8% and power by 14% on average across resistance-trained populations.

**Dosing:** Follow the product label (typically 5g daily, every day, no cycling needed). Take with any meal. No loading phase required — daily dosing reaches saturation within 3–4 weeks.

Monohydrate is the only form with robust clinical support; ignore marketing for HCl, ethyl ester, or buffered variants.

**Why it's in the stack:** More ATP per rep = more volume per session = more progressive overload = more muscle. Creatine is the foundation supplement because it directly improves the quality of every training session. It also supports cognitive function in some populations (Rae et al., 2003; [DOI](#)).

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#### 4. Omega-3 Fish Oil (EPA + DHA)

**What it does:** Modulates inflammation via prostaglandin and leukotriene pathways. Reduces training-induced systemic inflammation, supports cardiovascular health, improves triglyceride profiles, and may enhance muscle protein synthesis sensitivity.

**Dosing:** Follow the product label (typically 2–3g combined EPA/DHA per day, split AM and PM with fat-containing meals). Triglyceride (TG) form absorbs better than ethyl ester (EE) form. Qin et al. (2017; [DOI](#)) showed that an emulsified formulation produces 2.7–9.2× higher peak absorption than standard ethyl ester under fasted conditions.

**Why it's in the stack:** Training 6 days/week generates significant systemic inflammation. Omega-3 doesn't eliminate inflammation (you need some for adaptation), but it keeps chronic low-grade inflammation from accumulating into joint pain, poor recovery, and elevated cardiovascular markers. It is the anti-inflammatory floor beneath the training volume.

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#### 5. Amino Energy (EAAs + Caffeine + L-Theanine)

**What it does:** Provides essential amino acids (EAAs) as muscle protein synthesis substrates during training, caffeine for force production and fatigue delay, and L-theanine for focused energy without jitter or crash.

**Dosing:** Follow the product label (typically 1–2 scoops, 15–30 minutes pre-workout or sipped intra-workout). This is your pre-workout. Not a proprietary stimulant blend — a clean combination of EAAs, moderate caffeine, and L-theanine.

**Why it's in the stack:** During caloric deficit or extended training sessions, intramuscular amino acid pools deplete. EAAs during training provide MPS substrates without requiring a full meal in the training window. The caffeine + L-theanine combination (Giesbrecht et al., 2010; [DOI](#)) produces focused alertness without the anxiety or crash of high-stimulant pre-workouts.

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## What Is NOT In This Stack

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**No peptides.** Peptides are optimization tools for lifters who have exhausted natural potential (2+ years of disciplined training + nutrition). If you are reading this document, you are building the foundation. The peptides come later — see Peptide Protocol V3 when you are ready.

**No testosterone boosters beyond Fadogia/Tongkat.** Most "test booster" supplements are underdosed proprietary blends with no clinical support. Fadogia and Tongkat Ali are the two with the strongest mechanistic rationale. Everything else in the category is noise.

**No fat burners.** Caloric deficit + training + sleep is the fat loss engine. No pill replaces that. See Nutrition Plan V3 for the cutting architecture.

**No proprietary blend pre-workouts.** You should know exactly what you are putting in your body and in what dose. Amino Energy delivers EAAs, caffeine, and L-theanine in transparent doses. That is all you need.

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## How the Stack Fits Into the V3 System

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| Layer            | Plan                | This Stack's Role                                                             |
|------------------|---------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 — Training     | Training Program V3 | Creatine powers the reps. Amino Energy fuels the session.                     |
| 2 — Nutrition    | Nutrition Plan V3   | Omega-3 manages inflammation. Fadogia + Tongkat support hormonal environment. |
| 3 — Optimization | Peptide Protocol V3 | NOT YET. Build the foundation with this stack first. 2+ years minimum.        |

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## Key Takeaways

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- Exactly 5 supplements.** Fadogia Agrestis, Tongkat Ali, Creatine Monohydrate, Omega-3 Fish Oil, Amino Energy. Nothing else until the foundation is built.

2. **All dosing deferred to product labels.** Formulations vary by manufacturer. Follow the label on your specific product.
  3. **Fadogia requires cycling (5 on / 2 off).** Tongkat Ali, Creatine, Omega-3, and Amino Energy can be taken continuously.
  4. **No peptides in this stack.** This is the natural lifter's baseline. Peptide Protocol V3 is a separate, later decision.
  5. **Pair with NAC + TUDCA** from Nutrition Plan V3 if running Fadogia — liver and kidney support is mandatory.
  6. **Monitor bloodwork quarterly** if running Fadogia — testosterone, SHBG, liver enzymes, kidney function.
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## Sources

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**MEDICAL DISCLAIMER:** Educational only, not medical advice. Consult a physician before beginning any supplement regimen. Follow product labels for dosing. The compounds described reflect personal application and published research — they are not clinical prescriptions. Individual responses vary. [Flag: attorney review]

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